DAPPER DETAILING PROS

CERAMIC COATING SOP

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1 SOP — CERAMIC COATING EXECUTION

1.1 PURPOSE

This SOP outlines the correct process for applying ceramic coating to ensure proper bonding, even coverage, and a defect-free finish. The goal is to eliminate high spots, ensure durability, and maintain consistent quality across all applications.

1.2 REQUIRED SETUP

All tools and materials must be prepared before starting to avoid interruptions during application.

Ceramic coating bottle, applicator block with suede cloth, 10–15 clean microfiber towels, panel prep spray (IPA), and an inspection light must be available and ready for use.

1.3 NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

All technicians must follow these rules without exception:

- Work indoors only in a controlled environment
- Surface must be fully decontaminated and polished before application
- Use only clean, coating-safe microfiber towels
- Apply coating in small sections only
- High spots must never be left uncorrected

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2 PROCESS FLOW

2.1 SURFACE PREPARATION & FINAL CHECK (10–15 min)

Before applying coating, the surface must be inspected under proper lighting to ensure it is completely clean and free from defects. The paint must not have any dust, polish residue, or streaks.

All panels must then be wiped thoroughly using panel prep (IPA) to remove oils and ensure proper bonding. The surface should feel completely clean and dry before proceeding.

2.2 APPLICATION CONTROL

Coating must be applied in controlled sections to maintain consistency and prevent errors. Work strictly in sections of approximately 2 ft x 2 ft. Entire panels must not be coated at once.

2.3 COATING APPLICATION

Apply 5–8 drops of coating onto the applicator. Spread the coating evenly using a crosshatch pattern (left to right, then up and down) to ensure full coverage.

The layer must remain thin and uniform. Over-application should be avoided, as a thin layer provides proper bonding and easier leveling.

2.4 FLASH TIME MANAGEMENT

After application, allow the coating to flash based on product specifications, typically between 30 seconds and 2 minutes depending on temperature and conditions.

The surface should show a slight rainbow or haze effect before leveling.

Waiting too long will cause the coating to harden, making removal difficult and increasing the risk of defects.

2.5 LEVELING (WIPE OFF)

Leveling must be done immediately after the correct flash time using two microfiber towels:

Step	Action
First Wipe	Remove coating residue
Second Wipe	Final leveling and finish

The surface must be inspected from multiple angles to ensure no streaks, smears, or high spots remain.

2.6 PANEL SEQUENCE

Coating must be applied in a structured order to maintain consistency:

Order	Area
1	Roof
2	Hood
3	Trunk
4	Upper sides
5	Lower sides

Each section must be completed fully before moving to the next.

2.7 MULTI-LAYER APPLICATION (IF REQUIRED)

Coating Type	Application
3-Year Coating	Typically single layer
5-Year Coating	Second layer applied after 1–2 hours (or as per product guidelines)

When applying additional layers, the same process must be followed, ensuring the previous layer has been properly leveled.

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2.8 FINAL INSPECTION

A full inspection must be performed using an inspection light to identify any defects.

Check for high spots, streaks, missed areas, or uneven gloss. If defects are found during the workable window, they must be re-wiped immediately. If already cured, the affected area must be polished and re-coated.

2.9 CURING PROCESS

After application, the vehicle must remain indoors with no exposure to water.

Condition	Requirement
Immediate	No water contact
Minimum Cure Time	24 hours

2.10 TOOL HANDLING

After completion, all used materials must be handled properly. Suede applicators must be discarded, and microfiber towels used for coating must be separated and not reused for regular detailing work.

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3 TIME EXPECTATION (APPLICATION ONLY)

Vehicle Type	1 Tech	2 Techs
Hatchback	1.5 – 2 hrs	1 – 1.5 hrs
Sedan	2 – 3 hrs	1.5 – 2 hrs
SUV	3 – 4 hrs	2 – 3 hrs

This timing applies only to the coating application stage and does not include preparation or polishing.

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4 COMMON MISTAKES

- Applying excessive coating
- Working on large areas instead of sections
- Incorrect flash timing
- Poor lighting leading to missed defects
- Using contaminated or incorrect towels